

WARLOCK

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ELEMENTAL PLANES

WARLOCK

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ENDLESS SKIES: ELEMENTAL PLANE OF AIR

by Brian Suskind

Imagine an endless expanse of azure skies. A pearlescent radiance of no discernable source perpetually shines upon drifting white clouds, dancing on determined currents of air. Those traveling to this plane often imagine an empty void of gas, but this is far from the truth. Though no ubiquitous and permanent stretch of “ground” exists, motes of terrain, ranging from miles across to merely pebbles, do float through the firmament. These islands host a variety of animal and plant life, and some boast settlements and even cities. Dangers and wonders exist in equal measure for those brave enough to explore the Elemental Plane of Air.

Subjective Gravity. Visitors to the Elemental Plane of Air must grapple with the plane’s subjective gravity. For the most part, gravity functions as it does on Midgard, but—and it’s a big *but*—creatures determine for themselves the direction from which gravity pulls. For unattended objects, the plane has no gravity at all. A creature simply imagines “downward” to be in a certain direction, and it will “fall” in that direction. Each round, a falling creature moves 500 feet in a straight line. (Falling damage from striking a stationary object is determined as normal.)

The nature of the plane does not allow a

creature to control the strength of gravity, merely its direction. At the start of its turn, a creature can use a bonus action to make a DC 15 Wisdom check to set a new direction for gravity. On a success, the creature’s movement in the previous direction slows to 150 feet. On the next turn, the creature will “fall” 500 feet in the new direction. On a failure, the creature continues to fall in the same direction and has disadvantage on its next check to determine a new direction for gravity.

In order to land on a solid surface, a creature must do the following. At the beginning of the round after the creature has successfully set a new direction for gravity, it can make a DC 15 Wisdom check to instead choose no direction. This causes the creature to stop falling. If the creature is within 50 feet of a Large or bigger solid object, it will float down toward it at a rate of 15 feet per round.

Cosmology

The Elemental Plane of Air has two distinct regions: Endalaus and Storoval.

Endalaus. The upper layer of the plane is commonly called Endalaus (meaning *forever*) and is the one most often visited by planar travelers. Endalaus features endless open skies dotted by clouds and floating islands.

A complicated network of winds crisscrosses the layer, providing rapid travel for flying creatures. This layer is the home of powerful djinni lords, cloud giants, air elementals, and flying creatures of all kinds.

Storoval. Stretching out along the lower layer of the plane is Storoval, the Storm Wall. To a visitor standing on a mote of land in Endalaus, Storoval resembles a churning sea of black and gray storm clouds, stretching out forever. Lightning bolts flash upward from the surface of the storm, posing a hazard to nearby creatures in Endalaus. Within the layer, strong winds, driving rain, and obscuring clouds reduce visibility and present a dangerous environment for travelers. Storoval is the home of turbulent air elementals, storm giants, djinni, and any creatures who relish the storm.

NAVIGATING IN THE PLANE OF AIR

The complicated air currents of the wide-open skies can make navigation challenging. Luckily, motes of land larger than 200 feet across only drift at a rate of 1 foot per calendar year, making them useful as markers. Moreover, creatures in Endalaus can see twice as far as normal. For creatures without a flying speed, travel across the plane involves spotting a mote of land, falling toward it and successfully landing, and then sighting a new mote and repeating the process.

Despite Endalaus's reputation for endless blue skies, every weather condition exists here, including rain showers and thunderstorms. Amazed visitors often watch as the rain drifting "downward" from one cloud coalesces into another cloud. At times, the weather causes hazards for travelers. Natives instinctively avoid the strong winds, tornados, gales, and hurricanes when they occur. Due to the subjective gravity of the plane, tornados form into spinning toroids that pull nearby creatures into their whirling doom. In Storoval, storms or worse are the norm.

ELEMENTAL BREACHES

Planar storms in the open skies of the Elemental Plane of Air all feature driving winds, crashing thunder, and crackling lightning, but they take on additional traits depending on the other elemental planes involved. At a minimum, movement within any storm is considered difficult terrain and vision is lightly obscured:

- **Meteoric Tempest (Air/Earth).** A chaotic, convulsing plume of crashing stones and poisonous vapors, any creature that begins its turn within the area of the storm must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or take 5 (1d10) bludgeoning damage and 5 (1d10) poison damage. Moreover, for every minute spent within the storm, a creature must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw (+1 DC per each additional minute) or be poisoned.
- **Twisting Vortex Pyrostorm (Air/Fire).** This cyclonic firestorm features strong winds, weaving searing flames and clouds of superheated vapor into twisting vortices that revolve around a burning singularity. A creature that begins its turn within the area of the storm must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or take 5 (1d10) fire damage and 5 (1d10) bludgeoning damage. Failing the save by 5 or more results in the creature being flung 20 feet in a random direction. Moreover, for every minute spent within the storm, a creature must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or gain a level of exhaustion from the intense heat.
- **Typhonic Maelstrom (Air/Water).** At the heart of this storm of churning air and rain is a massive aerial whirlpool, dragging anything caught in its grasp into the void. A creature that begins its turn in the area of the storm is pulled 10 feet toward its center and must succeed on a

DC 12 Strength saving throw or be pulled an additional 40 feet, taking 11 (2d10) bludgeoning damage, and restrained by wind and water. Failing the save by 5 or more results in the creature beginning to suffocate. At the end of each of its turns, a restrained creature can repeat the Strength saving throw, ending the effect on a success.

Reaching the Plane

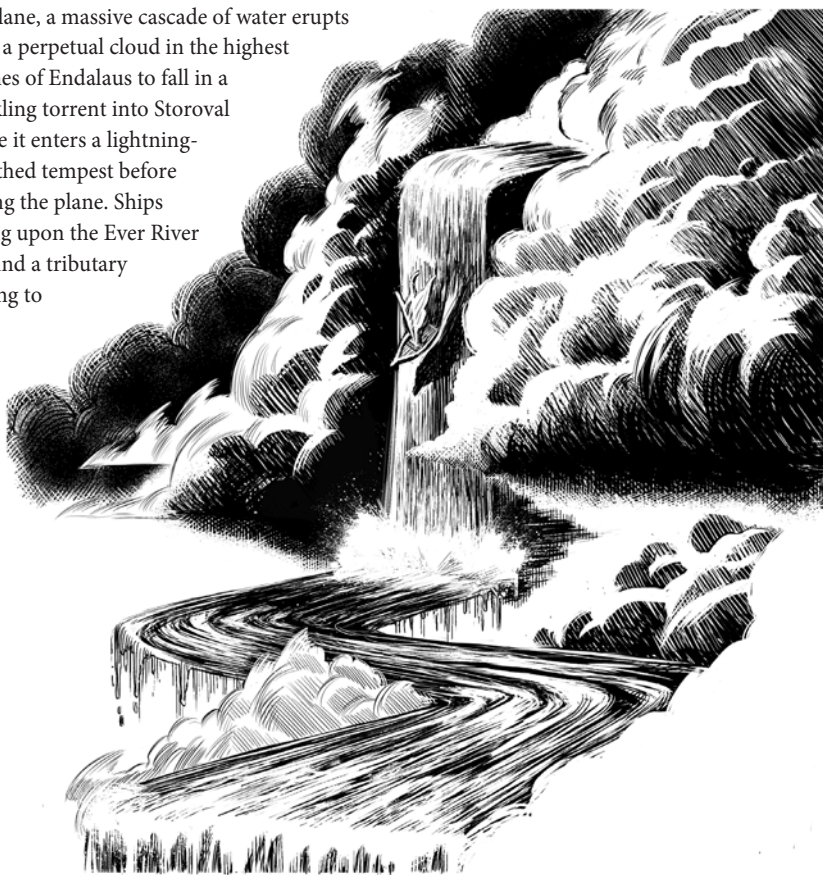
Apart from forcible rifts in the fabric of the dimensions, the whims of Hune the Door Lord, and various spell-created portals, there are several other methods to travel to the Elemental Plane of Air.

Etherfalls (Ever River). Visible from across the plane, a massive cascade of water erupts from a perpetual cloud in the highest reaches of Endalaus to fall in a sparkling torrent into Storoval where it enters a lightning-wreathed tempest before exiting the plane. Ships sailing upon the Ever River can find a tributary leading to

the Etherfalls, though the passage down the cascade, not to mention traversing the tempest, poses significant risks.

Pyramid Marked Door. In the Mharoti city of Harkesh, north of where the Sumarra River flows beneath the great aqueduct, is an establishment called Flights of Fancy. Specializing in flying creatures and flying magic, the shop's owner, Zingara, guards a door emblazoned with the alchemical symbol for air. A creature stepping through this doorway emerges in the city of Qasfi Alasam in the Elemental Plane of Air.

Verdant Storm. Located in an equatorial region of Asaph, the Green Planet, is a swirling vortex of green-tinted clouds.



Guarded by air elementals, this magical gateway offers a somewhat turbulent passage between the planet orbiting Midgard and the Elemental Plane of Air.

Wybren (World Tree). An 80-foot-wide tree branch stretches a mile between two floating clouds. Creatures can pass between Yggdrasil and the Elemental Plane of Air by climbing up or down this World Tree branch.

WHIRLWIND SPHERECRAFT

This fist-sized stone sphere is banded with iron strips decorated with twisting, coiling lines reminiscent of a vortex. The carvings move and flow across the surface of the sphere.

Professor and geologist, the gnome Ignacio Vartan was always envious of the great explorers, traveling to the farthest reaches of the world. He'd amassed a huge collection of travel tomes, works detailing those fated adventurers, and devoured every word.

Years passed and perhaps Ignacio would have languished in the forgotten stacks of academia if not for a strange scroll purchased from a traveling sage. It was old, complicated, and difficult to decipher, but with an uncharacteristic boldness, he fumbled through the casting only to be teleported to a ruin covered mote of stone suspended in the middle of a raging storm between the Elemental Planes of Air and Earth. Even more surprising, the storm spoke to him.

The two realized they were like minds and long to see the multiverse. So they devised a plan to place the storm in an artifact capable of making their dreams of adventure come true. It is not known precisely what became of Ignacio. Some legends have it that his plan succeeded, and he created the *Whirlwind Spherecraft*, escaping his mote of rock to travel the planes. Other accounts maintain that the plan went awry, binding both the gnome's soul and the spirit of the storm into the stone sphere. What is certainly true, the great work, *By Wind and Will: A Gnome's Travels Throughout the Planes*, is studied

in many universities. It is also true that the strange stone sphere called the *Whirlwind Spherecraft* has appeared in many accounts over the centuries, to be used by one explorer or another before being lost again.

WHIRLWIND SPHERECRAFT

Wondrous Item, Fabled (5th-Level and Higher Abilities Require Attunement)

This fist-sized stone sphere has bands of iron inset into its surface and engraved with a storm-like image that seems to move slowly across its surface. While holding the sphere, you have advantage on Intelligence checks regarding elementals or the planes.

Ride the Storm (Requires Attunement). As your level increases, you gain the following benefits while holding the sphere.

5th Level. If you use an action to rotate one of the iron bands on the sphere, a powerful whirlwind lifts a circle of stone beneath you with a diameter of 5 feet into the air. The stone floats for a number of hours equal to your proficiency bonus, either all at once or in several shorter flights with each using a minimum of 1 minute from the duration.

The stone moves at your mental command. It has a flying speed of 15 feet and can carry you and any equipment you are wearing or carrying. Ranged attacks have disadvantage against you while you are traveling upon your stone. The effect ends if you step off the stone. When you do so, the stone vanishes and you descend 60 feet per round, taking no damage from falling.

As your level increases, the stone can move faster and carry more creatures and any equipment they are wearing or carrying:

- 30 feet and additional willing Medium or smaller creatures equal to half of your proficiency bonus (9th).
- 45 feet and additional willing Medium or smaller creature equal to your proficiency bonus (13th).
- 60 feet (17th).

9th Level. As an action, you can cast the *plane shift* spell, affecting the entire vessel and all onboard. The destination is restricted to the Elemental Plane of Air, the Elemental Plane of Earth, or the Material Plane. Once used, this ability can't be used in this way again until 24 hours have passed.

13th Level. While traveling upon the stone, you can use an action to rotate three iron bands on the sphere. The winds lifting the stone form a 30-foot-tall cylinder with a 10-foot radius, centered on the flying stone. Any creature in the cylinder, other than you and those you chose to ride the stone with you, must make a Strength saving throw (DC equal to 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Charisma modifier), taking 6d8 bludgeoning damage and being flung up to 20 feet away from the whirlwind in a random direction and knocked prone on a failed save or taking half the damage and suffering no other effects on a successful one.

The whirlwind lasts for a minute. Once you use the sphere in this way, it can't be used in this way again until you finish a long rest.

17th Level. While piloting the vessel, you can cast the *reverse gravity* spell as an action. Once used, the vessel cannot be used again in this way for 1d4 + 1 days.

Inhabitants

As might be expected, flying creatures of all manner make their home in the Elemental Plane of Air. Air elementals make up the largest portion of its population, though various other creatures, entities, and beings call this plane home. Dragons especially seem to visit the plane frequently, lured by the freedom of unlimited space to fly.

The plane is also the domain of powerful djinni lords—elemental genie lords called “storm sheiks”—that construct beautiful palaces atop and around floating motes, forming strongholds of graceful towers and shining minarets that radiate outward in all directions. Most djinn live in independent

holdings and are fiercely protective of their isolation, though all storm sheiks acknowledge the rule of the Grand Calipha to some extent. A typical sheik controls a palace community of 2–20 lower-ranked djinn and jinnborn as well as elemental servants and guardians. Fantastic cities encircle the palaces of some of the most powerful djinni lords and offer safe ports for voidships and other planar travelers.

The following are suggestions for various Plane of Air encounters:

- **Low Level Encounters.** **Couatls**, flying animals (such as **eagles** and **hawks**), **hippogriffs**, **radiant spark swarms** (see *Tome of Beasts* 2), **storm spirits** (see *Creature Codex*), **tusked skyfish** (see *Tome of Beasts*), and wyrmling **dragons**.
- **Mid-Level Encounters.** **Air elementals**, **al-Aeshma genies** (see *Tome of Beasts*), **fulminars** (see *Creature Codex*), **hongaeks** (see *Tome of Beasts* 2), **invisible stalkers**, **liosalfars** (see *Tome of Beasts*), **sparks** (see *Tome of Beasts*), **wyverns**, and young **dragons**.
- **High Level Encounters.** **Djinn**, **noth-norren** (see *Tome of Beasts* 2), older **dragons**, **planetars**, **rocs**, **stellar rorqual** (see *Tome of Beasts* 2), **theullai** (see *Tome of Beasts*), and various **sphinxes**.

Locations of Interest

Most motes of land in the Elemental Plane of Air feature ruins, a palace, or some interesting occupant.

Citadel of Bright Wind. This palace is the seat of power for the Storm Caliphate, ruler of the djinn. It is a vast, floating oval-shaped diamond carved by wind and magic into towers, domes, gardens, plazas, and labyrinths. The city of Qasfi Alasam encircles the citadel. The complex features no stairways, forcing visitors without the ability to fly to rely upon air elemental guides. Smaller spheres of ice and stone orbit

ELEMENTAL BREACH

The elemental planes of Midgard embody the core aspects of air, earth, fire, and water, representing the building blocks of creation.

These planes hang from the branches of the World Tree, each filled with strange creatures, fantastic locations, and thrilling adventures. Though they do not generally have extensive physical overlap, the planes intermittently interact with one another and can form elemental breaches. These come in two varieties. The more violent and transitory instances, called coterminous storms, are the more common, though why or even when they occur is not fully understood—a churning tempest of two clashing elemental energies, erupting without warning. The more permanent instances, or coterminous zones, can lie dormant for ages, existing in some complex, arcane dance between the planes as each plane's influence on the locale ebbs and flows over time.

Creating a Breach. The exact nature of these elemental breaches is left for GMs to fashion, according to the needs of the adventure. As a guideline, GMs wishing to create a breach should choose an element (air, earth, fire, or water), which is different from the plane the PCs currently occupy, and then envision an appropriate phenomenon made up of the two elements. For example, if the adventure is currently in the Elemental Plane of Fire, a coterminous storm with the Elemental Plane of Air could feature swirling tornados of wind that pull flames into a fire vortex. If they are in

the Elemental Plane of Water, a storm with the Elemental Plane of Earth might be composed of massive rocks clashing together in raging waves.

Formation. A coterminous storm erupts into existence over the course of 3 rounds, beginning with a 30-foot radius and growing by 60 feet per round. Some storms remain small while others continue to grow until they dissipate. They can last between 5 rounds and 10 minutes, though some have been reported to last for hours or even days. Coterminous zones are generally permanent or cyclical to some degree, and they can be treated as storms made permanent although their effects are generally less tempestuous.

Hazards. Creatures attempting to move through such an elemental breach risk various hazards, depending on the elements involved. The descriptions of each plane provide some example phenomena.

Planar Travel. Using an elemental breach, travelers can attempt to cross from their current plane into the coterminous elemental plane. To make the crossing, a creature must reach a point within 15 feet of the center of the breach and use an action to make a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw to will themselves across the planar barrier. On a failed save, the creature is forcibly pushed 120 feet away from the center. On a successful save, the creature emerges at the edge of a similar elemental breach in the destination plane.

it, housing guest chambers, barracks, and impressive defensive armaments. The latest name of the citadel was chosen by the current ruler of the djinn, Calipha Astallah al-Zahra bint Husam al-Balil.

Great Maelstrom. Deep within Storoval, howling winds draw the unwary toward a titanic whirlpool of storms and misfortune. The eternal whirlwind is large enough to swallow whole cities, if any were near enough to fall into its clutches. Each round, creatures caught in the maelstrom take 10 (3d6)

bludgeoning damage and 10 (3d6) necrotic damage, and they have disadvantage on any ability check or saving throw they make to escape. If a creature is pulled into the center of the maelstrom, it appears in the air above Evermaw, Plane of Undeath.

Qasfi Alasam, Steel City of Shining Ice. This large city is the capital of the djinn and rests on a massive white cloud that encircles the Citadel of Bright Wind, the palace of the Grand Calipha. The cloud beneath the city is infused with enough magic to render it

solid. The spires and domes of Qasfi Alasam are fashioned from magically stable ice and polished steel, giving the city a cold, stark feel. However, the population—djinn, jinns, humans, and a scattering of other planar races—is welcoming and joyful for the most part. Some notable locations in Qasfi Alasam are the Jade Mosque of Endless Contemplations, the Flowing Gardens of Delight, and the Endless Souk, an enclosed marketplace that's larger on the inside.

Rorqual Brumes. Floating through the worst storms of Storoval are a few relatively calm fogbanks of swirling clouds and eddying, nutrient-rich mist. **Stellar rorqual** (see *Tome of Beasts 2*) come to breed and give birth. The gigantic cetaceans generally ignore other creatures in the brumes, unless they pose a threat to the mothers or young. Rorqual brumes offer a rare safe zone in the otherwise perilous Storoval. Creatures that finish a long rest in a brume gain 10 temporary hit points that last for 8 hours.

Shattered Spire. Resting on a mote of land is a broken tower of cracked basalt, this towering spire was created by the four mighty Wind Lords soon after they manifested from the last breath of the giant Aurgelmir. It still features engravings honoring its creators: Chergui (East Wind), Shemral (West Wind), Khamsin (South Wind), and Boreas (North Wind). When Boreas turned against his siblings 2,000 years ago, he froze the spire in his anger, fracturing the upper floors. Recently, an archeological expedition of aeromancers from Aerdvall has begun to explore the spire, but mysterious injuries plague the team.

Personages of Note

Some of the plane's interesting inhabitants are described below.

Calipha Astallah of Bright Wind. A beautiful monarch with a bright outlook, Astallah al-Zahra bint Husam al-Balil (**djinni**) is one of the youngest rulers to take the Monsoon Throne. Though she still mourns the loss of her father, Caliph Husam, Astallah balances the often-squabbling ranks of her people with deft diplomacy and grace. Since taking the throne, Astallah has sought to avoid conflicts that might put her people at risk. Her other titles include Calipha of the Djinn, Mistress of Bright Wind, Daughter of Breezes, Commander of the Winds, and Storm of the Righteous.

Gray Sulka, Pirate Queen of the Hungry Tempest. Feared across the plane, even by the powerful djinn, Gray Sulka is a **doppelganger** buccaneer that shares a telepathic bond with her **carnivorous ship** (see *Tome of Beasts 2*), the *Hungry Tempest*. Sulka and her pirate crew operate out of a concealed redoubt deep within the storms of Storoval. Provoked by her raids on djinni holdings and other merchant vessels, she boasts a hefty bounty for her capture or elimination.

Lord Fuaran of Aqueous Imports. This gnome wizard and craftsman operates a small fleet of airships that "mine" clouds for water with a technique of his own invention. Once collected, he sells the water to the cities and communities of the plane. Currently, Fuaran alone knows the trick of cloud scooping, and he zealously guards his invention, often attacking other airships and creatures who seem too nose-y for their own good.

Shabaan bin-Aqeel al-Basatar, General of the Azure Thunderbolts. The fierce and temperamental leader of the Citadel of Bright Wind's famed defenders, Shabaan (**djinni**) commands the djinni and elemental soldiers of the Thunder Legion. Though from all appearances loyal to the Calipha, Shabaan



chafes under Astallah's peaceful reforms and longs for the days of the old Caliph's territorial expansions.

Adventure Hooks

Those brave enough to adventure in the Elemental Plane of Air contend with its variable gravity as well as its often-dangerous inhabitants. Despite the risk, great beauty and rewards await the courageous. A few possible adventures in the plane are described below:

- The Mharoti Empire's Collegium Elemental recently sent a group of professors and advanced students to the Elemental Plane of Air seeking a floating mineral rumored to lighten anything

made from it. Using this mineral in the construction of new warships would make the Mharoti fleet the fastest in Midgard. However, the team is long overdue, and High Lector Jaaduu-gar Behistun seeks brave adventurers to find the lost expedition and return with the precious mineral.

- Calipha Astallah summons the PCs to her palace in secret, having heard of their prowess even in the skies of the Elemental Plane of Air. In order to solidify her grip on the throne, she needs the *Azure Scepter*, a djinni artifact of ancient power. The scepter is located deep within Storoval, in a trapped and guarded dungeon fashioned from solidified storm clouds. Great treasures will be theirs if the PCs return with the scepter. Unbeknownst to the heroes though, General Shabaan of the Azure Thunderbolts wishes to claim the scepter—and the throne—for himself and has dispatched an elite squad of jinnborn to the Stormwrought Delve.
- While in the Elemental Plane of Air, Malvie, a **sprite**, approaches the PCs with a plea for aid. A group of air elementals have captured a raiding party of Skybind aeromancers from Aerdvall and their powerful skyship. The aeromancers were seeking to capture the **air elementals** for their floating city. Malvie offers the PCs the location of an abandoned—and unlooted—djinni's palace as a reward for rescuing her friends.

FATHOMLESS SHOALS: ELEMENTAL PLANE OF WATER

by Kelly Pawlik

The Elemental Plane of Water is an endless expanse of liquid broken up by the occasional submerged land mass, reef, or eternally sinking hulk. The unending waters are in constant motion as temperamental, ever-shifting currents create wide, sweeping travel lanes only to narrow, veer suddenly, or change direction entirely.

Despite the vast, seemingly empty expanses of water, life abounds in the plane. The waters are rife with plankton and other microscopic organisms. Mollusks and crustaceans stud the land masses while fish of all sorts swim the expanse, feeding on their favored prey. Merfolk cities to rival any metropolis have been erected upon continent-sized reefs. Some inhabitants have grown to unimaginable size, and rumors speak of monsters the size of Midgard's moons in the far reaches.

Cold blue light filters through the central regions of the plane, penetrating through water and solid alike by some weird property it possesses. The farthest reaches however are as pitch black and frigid as deepest space. Where metaphysically close to the other elemental planes, the light changes, becoming a hellish orange-red near the Elemental Plane of Fire, a harsh white where it touches the Elemental Plane of Air, and a muddy brown where it meets the Elemental Plane of Earth.

Cosmology

Its ever-shifting currents combined with its seemingly limitless size make the task of mapping the Elemental Plane of Water a virtual impossibility. The difficulty is compounded by the distortion of relative distances experienced even by creatures adapted to aquatic environments.

Planar scholars posit that the perceptual phenomenon is a result of the fluctuating viscosity of the waters combined with the unique gravitic force exerted by each solid object native to the plane.

The core of the plane, Bittereye, is a roughly spherical mass of rotating ice that is more than twice the size of Midgard's sun. This central mass holds the Arp of Gloaig, which serves as its primary source of natural light. Defying the physical laws that govern the rest of the plane, Bittereye has no gravitational field, despite its mass. Instead, chunks of ice that break away, some the size of terrestrial worlds, are slowly flung away from it, with each ice mass driving other objects away from it.

Surrounding Bittereye is the Aquan Totality, which is the turbulent, endless expanse of fresh water most Material Plane residents think of when they think of the plane. The Aquan Totality is punctuated with numerous

salinized oceans, each of which has formed around a sizable solid mass. Most of the civilizations that have developed in the plane have done so in these discrete bodies of water.

The outer reaches of the plane, called the Stygian Veil, are a lightless expanse of thick vapor. Where it is closer to the Totality, the Veil has a spongy, almost solid texture, but it thins the farther one gets from the center of the plane.

Subjective Directional Gravity. Like the Elemental Plane of Air, visitors to the Elemental Plane of Water experience subjective gravity. Unlike the other plane though, each solid object native to the Elemental Plane of Water has its own gravitational field with a strength determined by the size of the object in question. In simple terms, smaller objects “sink” toward the largest solid mass in their vicinity at a rate of $10 + 2d100$ feet per round. For every 100 feet an object sinks, the currents it is subjected to cause it to drift $1d20$ feet laterally in a direction of the GM’s choice. A creature that succeeds on a DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check ceases to “sink” and can move in the direction it desires. A “sinking” creature that strikes a stationary object can use its reaction to make a DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check, taking 3 (1d6) damage for every 50 feet it sank on the turn in which it struck the object on a failed save or no damage on a successful save. Creatures with a swim speed do not need to make checks to move normally or avoid damage from striking solid objects.

Pressure. The waters of the plane exert the same amount of pressure on solid objects immersed in them, regardless of the differing factors between the various bodies of water. In practical terms, this allows creatures to travel safely from region to region within the plane without worrying about decompression sickness, otherwise known as the bends.

Likewise, most magic that allows travel between planes, such as *plane shift*, protects its subjects from the negative effects of

moving from the relatively high-pressure environment of the Elemental Plane of Water to a lower pressure one, such as that of the Material Plane.

ELEMENTAL BREACHES

Despite how vicious they can be, planar storms in the boundless depths of the Elemental Plane of Water are surprisingly silent, often taking inexperienced marine explorers by surprise. These storms always showcase multiple competing currents, resulting in toroidal rings or other nightmares of swirling water. Some examples of coterminous effects in the plane follow:

- **Drownspout (Water/Air).** Where the howling winds of the Elemental Plane of Air meet the currents of the Aquan Totality, immense vortices form. At initiative count 20, all Huge or smaller creatures located within 1,000 feet of a drownspout are pulled 100 feet toward its eye. A creature can use its reaction to make a DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check to remain unmoved from its position. Creatures within 500 feet of the drownspout’s eye have disadvantage on Strength (Athletics) checks they make to move away or maintain their position. Creatures that start their turn within 150 feet of the eye of the drownspout take 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage. The damage increases to 14 (4d6), once a creature moves within 100 feet of the eye, and to 21 (6d6) once they are within 50 feet. Creatures that have 0 hp while they are within 100 feet of the eye have disadvantage on death saving throws. A creature that is sucked through the eye of a drownspout takes 52 (15d6) bludgeoning damage and is deposited in a random location on the Elemental Plane of Air. The eye of a drownspout usually has a radius of 30 feet.
- **Seething Froth (Water/Fire).** Where the heat of the Elemental Plane of Fire

boils the oceans of the Elemental Plane of Water, it creates superheated steam bubbles that cook living flesh. A creature that starts its turn inside of, or moves through, an area of seething froth must make a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw, taking 17 (5d6) fire damage and losing a Hit Die (as though it was expended to no effect) on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one. If the seething froth forms around a land mass or other solid object, the object is affected as though subjected to *heat metal*.

- **Silt Churn (Water/Earth).** Where the soil of the Elemental Plane of Earth finds its way into the Aquan Totality, it creates conflicting currents of thick mud filled with razor shards of stone. A creature that starts its turn in silt churn must make a DC 16 Strength saving throw, becoming restrained and taking 9 (2d8) bludgeoning and 5 (1d10) slashing damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one. Creatures in the churn are heavily obscured. Areas of silt churn are usually 75 feet wide by 75 feet high by 150 feet long but can be much larger. The length of an area of silt churn is always double that of its other dimensions.

Reaching the Plane

Traveling to the Elemental Plane of Water from Midgard can be accomplished in many ways. The most commonly used method is via the *plane shift* spell. Several of Midgard's shadow roads can deposit a traveler in the plane. The Lotus Road, for instance, can lead those upon it directly to the Pearl Fane while those on the Pontoretto can exit to the frigid Glittering Hollow, and the Grey Way leads to the merfolk city of Kinvlemere. And there's a portal to the plane in the ruined marid city of Ammalsine at the bottom of Lake Debari (see *Southlands Worldbook*).

Mbardhi Pti. Creatures that enter the submerged tunnels located among the roots

of the world tree Mbardhi Pti, a 400-foot-tall mangrove towering over the coast near the Gardens of Carnessa, might find themselves transported to a wide array of locations scattered across the plane. The serpentine roots of the tree seem to have a malevolent life of their own, and those who seek to use the tunnels are at risk of being pulled beneath the waves or crushed in their constricting coils.

Pearl Fane (Ever River). The Pasha of the Pearl Fane intimates that the origins of the Ever River are located near his seat in the Elemental Plane of Water. Whether or not this is true, a strong current of the waterway passes underneath the main entrance of his gem-encrusted palace. Other branches of the Ever River can deposit travelers on the Vaparean Shore, where the Aquan Totality meets the Stygian Veil, or on the banks of Lappfite Beach in Kinvlemere. Creatures that swim to the Elemental Plane of Water via the Ever River are able to breathe air as well as water until they leave the plane.

Rivers Styx and Lethe. Though they are dangerous waters to travel, the Rivers Styx and Lethe both cut sluggish black ribbons through the plane. The wraith haunted River Lethe winds all the way through the plane, boring a tunnel directly through Bittereye and increasing the danger in that already hazardous location.

AQUA DESCENDER

This milky, translucent orb appears to be crafted from the eye of a creature of unimaginable size and coated in mother-of-pearl. Squirming cilia and flexing optic nerves guide the craft through the currents. Creatures that have observed the vehicle in motion report an uncomfortable sensation of being watched, even hours after it is no longer in sight.

After its death, the three eyes of the dead aboleth titan Pzu Gxa Ik were plucked from its drifting corpse and crafted into a trio of *Aqua Descenders*, vehicles that can be used to traverse the elemental planes. Each of the

orb-like vehicles is large enough to hold a dozen standing Medium creatures and their gear. The interior of each descender is filled with the aboleth's vitreous slime. A pair of straps on the orb's floor are used to secure the pilot to the craft while a studded-steel skullcap is suspended from the ceiling by a brain stem-like stalk. Despite the fluid filling the craft, passengers can breathe freely.

AQUA DESCENDER

Wondrous Item, Fabled (5th-Level and Higher Abilities Require Attunement)

While strapped to the floor of this vessel and with the skullcap situated on your head, you can mentally direct it to move in any direction. It has a fly and swim speed of 150 feet per round (approximately 2 miles per hour).

If you aren't attuned to the aqua descender when you place the skullcap upon your head, you must succeed on a DC 25 Wisdom saving throw or have disadvantage on Wisdom checks and Wisdom saving

throws for the duration of your voyage and for 24 hours after exiting the vehicle.

Eye of Command (Requires Attunement).

As your level increases, you gain the following benefits while piloting the vessel.

5th Level. While within the vessel, you and all creatures with you are immune to cold and fire damage.

9th Level. As an action, you can cast the *plane shift* spell, affecting the entire vessel and all onboard. The destination is restricted to the Elemental Plane of Fire, the Elemental Plane of Water, or the Material Plane. Once used, this ability can't be used in this way again until 24 hours have passed.

13th Level. As an action on your turn, you can make three tentacle attacks with the vessel. You are considered to have proficiency with the tentacles, and when you make an attack



with them, you use your Wisdom modifier in place of your Strength or Dexterity modifier. Each tentacle deals 2d10 bludgeoning damage.

17th Level. While piloting the vessel, you can cast the *dominate monster* spell as an action. Once used, the vessel cannot be used again in this way for 1d4 + 1 days.

Inhabitants

Numerous intelligent species make their homes in the Elemental Plane of Water. Marids are native to the plane, and the Pasha of the Pearl Fane, a marid of immense power and status, rules the plane from his throne.

Merfolk. Merfolk settlements have been erected across the plane, ranging from isolated hamlets of only a few dozen individuals to the teeming metropolis of Kinlemere, which boasts more than 250,000 residents. Where merfolk thrive, so too can merrow be found in great numbers. While they are hunted ruthlessly by their age-old enemies, the merrow city of Brine offers a haven to the maligned creatures.

Nomadic bands of sahuagin rove the endless waves, and it is said that they have discovered a secret that allows them to swiftly travel the vast distances between the oceans.

Elementals. Water elementals, as turbulent and temperamental as any body of water, can be found in untold numbers across the plane as can lesser elemental-kin, such as ice mephits. Though they aren't native, small communities of aboleth have migrated to the plane to hatch their eons-spanning plots.

Others. All types of fish, from tiny freshwater carp to giant sunfish to megalodons swim the waters of the plane as do marine dinosaurs, such as mosasaurs and plesiosaurs.

Ocean-going leviathans, such as sea serpents, dragon turtles, and the dread kraken can be found in the plane, though even there they are thankfully rare. Giant cephalopods, such as octopus and squid, are more common. Notably absent among the plane's denizens are whales and marine mammals,

though a few addled-seeming travelers have made wild claims about encounters with vapor-surfing, carnivorous whales in the Stygian Veil.

Coral reefs make up most of the land masses in the plane—hundreds of thousands of square miles of area. A wide variety of seaweeds are scattered throughout the reefs (and elsewhere) and the combination of vegetation and coral substructure provide for rich ecosystems. Like the plant life found in most Material Plane oceans, it generally grows no taller than 30 feet, though within the Coriola Forest the seaweed can reach heights of 500 feet and provide ample hiding spots for ambush predators and prey fish alike.

Locations of Interest

A few of the many notable locations are detailed below.

Arp of Gloaig. This triptych of crystalline vortices is encased at the center of Bittereye at the ever-moving heart of the plane. The speed and direction in which the Arp rotates changes occasionally for reasons no scholar has yet been able to fathom, though it undeniably generates more light the faster it spins. The blue light it produces radiates outward through Bittereye and extends through most of the Aquan Totality, dimming the farther it travels before fading entirely near the Stygian Veil.

It is generally thought that the Arp of Gloaig is encased in solid ice since the rotation of Bittereye matches its movement. This belief is not true though, for the Arp actually spins in a nutrient-rich, high-viscosity, supercooled liquid. Living organisms that survive exposure to the liquid undergo rapid, beneficial mutation.

Glittering Hollow. The outer portion of Bittereye, and the ice that breaks free from it, are riddled with tunnels formed of faceted ice. The light that radiates outward from the Arp of Gloaig is at its brightest as it passes through the ice, creating the blinding effect

the tunnels are named for. Expeditions, mostly mounted from the Material Plane, are occasionally made to map the Glittering Hollow in order to find a path to the Arp at Bittereye's heart. The only complete map that has been produced is kept secured in the Pasha of the Pearl Fane's treasury.

Travelers without magical protection take 14 (4d6) cold damage at the start of each turn they spend in the Glittering Hollow or elsewhere in Bittereye.

Kinvlemere. The largest city in the plane also holds its greatest single concentration of merfolk and is by far the location most visited by creatures of the Material Plane. The metropolis is a work of art that integrates stone and crystal construction with bridges and walkways of living coral. Portions of the city, including its largest marketplaces, sit beneath great domes that allow any creature contained within them to breathe freely underwater. The city is located in the Sea of Pelenos and is completely surrounded by the 340,000 square miles of the Ullicor Ring Reef.

Pearl Fane. The marid Pasha Saliandla is the acknowledged ruler of the Elemental Plane of Water. His Pearl Fane is carved from a single perfect pink pearl he stole from Estreid, the Queen of Oysters. The aggrieved mollusk god sought to reacquire her treasure for centuries until Saliandla placated her by securing his fane to her shell. From time-to-time, Estreid forgets she has made peace with the pasha and seeks agents to assassinate him and return the Pearl Fane to her.

The fane itself is a confusing warren of small courtyards connected by wide corridors. Creatures that enter the fane with the



intent of harming its primary resident find themselves caught in a loop of corridors, rooms, and plazas until the pasha tires of their presence and releases a battery of giant barracuda to devour them.

Spire of Qar. This spindle of solid onyx relocated itself from the Elemental Plane of Earth to the Elemental Plane of Water an eon ago during a particularly violent coterminous storm. Delighting in its uniqueness, the genie-kind of the plane built Nacre—their mother-of-pearl city—around it.

The marid Empress Quarrimaj built her palace, a replica of the Pearl Fane, carved from a giant, magically created golden pearl, in the in the genie city. Her decision, along with her harsh criticisms of Saliandla, has rewarded her with the increasing support of her peers as well as a steady stream of mortal petitioners attracted to her unique ability to grant wishes.

Personages of Note

Some of the plane's interesting inhabitants are described below.

Believers of the Blue Tide.

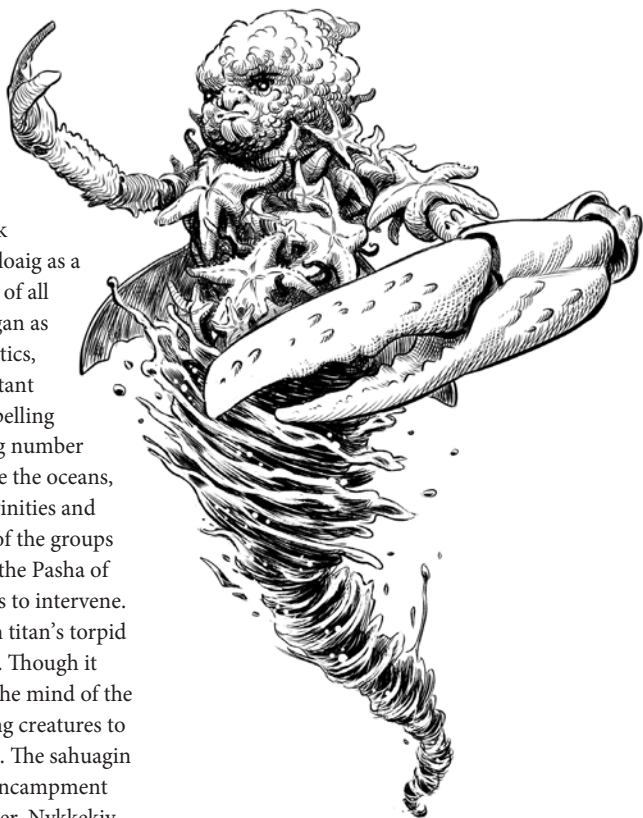
This society of scholars and philosophers, mostly of merfolk descent, worships the Arp of Gloaig as a god and believes it is the origin of all life. While the organization began as a collective of like-minded ascetics, it has become increasingly militant as its popularity grows. A compelling young believer and her growing number of adherents have begun to rove the oceans, destroying temples to other divinities and assaulting their faithful. News of the groups actions has reached the ears of the Pasha of the Pearl Fane who seeks agents to intervene.

Pzu Gxa Ik. The blind aboleth titan's torpid body has been sinking for eons. Though it slumbers in a death-like state, the mind of the alien creature plots still, drawing creatures to it in order to carry out its plans. The sahuagin Slime-Slick Band has built an encampment on the titan's body, and its leader, Nykkekiy, is in constant communion with it. Through their telepathic link, Pzu Gxa Ik shares its desires with its disciple, and the warlock-priest accedes to its master's requests without hesitation. The sahuagin's current command is to reconnect its god with its missing eyes.

Adventure Hooks

Adventures in the Elemental Plane of Water can take many forms. Consider the following ideas to introduce the location to your campaign:

- The merfolk sage Sallashalla has heard that the Juno-Fin Band of sahuagin has discovered how to cross from one planar ocean to another in a matter of hours, regardless of the actual distance between them. She makes a request of the characters to find out if her information



is true, and if so, she wants them to steal the secret from the sahuagin.

- One of the *Aqua Descenders* crosses paths with the characters. When the characters enter the craft, it connects itself to one of them and begins to travel toward Bittereye, despite the commands of its pilot. What reason does the vehicle have to travel to the least hospitable region of the plane?
- A tsunami striking the coast of the Wasted West has swept the town of Maravahr into the Stygian Veil. The characters, who were resting in the village when it shifted planes, must discover the secret of the settlements translocation and reverse it before the village is stuck in the cold black shoals forever.

ONYX DEPTHS: ELEMENTAL PLANE OF EARTH

by Jonathan Miley

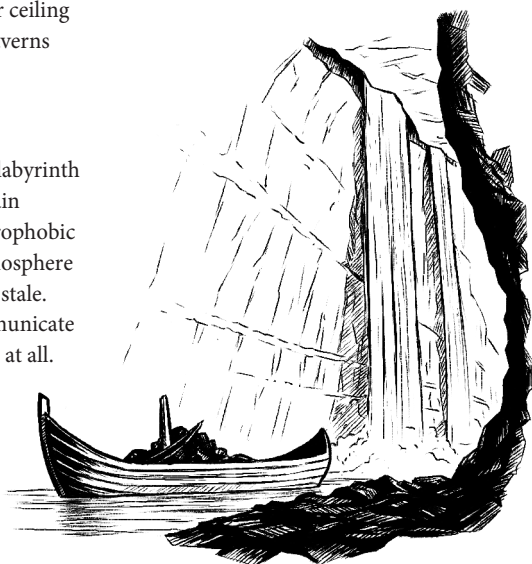
The Elemental Plane of Earth is a place of darkness and primordial earth. The majority of the plane is devoid of light, save for the odd luminescent fungal patch or roaming creature. This is a realm of subterranean mountains and canyons, of endless caverns that journey through stone in twisting tunnels. Artificial structures are all made of precious stone or carved directly into the rockfaces that reach deep into the darkness above. Those that have ventured up past the tallest mountain peaks are only greeted with the discovery of another ceiling of stone, dripping stalactites—just caverns within caverns.

Cosmology

The plane is a massive subterranean labyrinth of tunnels, interspersed with mountain ranges and ravines. The often-claustrophobic environs are earth and rock. The atmosphere is breathable, though a bit dusty and stale. The plane's denizens primarily communicate in Terran, if they know any language at all. Gravity functions as those from the Material Plane would call “normal.”

ELEMENTAL BREACHES

Though most of the plane exists in varying degrees of never-ending darkness and stone, there are a few points where the other elemental planes intrude, creating places where the two elements come together in potentially dangerous circumstances. It might be worth pointing out that, unlike the breaches in other elemental planes, those of the Elemental Plane of Earth are more static, less volatile, perhaps owing to the more unhurried nature of realm.



Obsidian Marsh (Earth/Water). A region of mud and running streams, this is where a connection to the Elemental Plane of Water lies as the Ever River bursts into the plane. Where the waters enter is a violent cataract, and the river then proceeds to snake throughout the realm. But the area immediately around the falls is dotted with stretches of deep, sucking mud (treat as quicksand), where many creatures have sunken to their demise. Steep slopes of stone gird much of the marsh.

Weird creatures are known to live here, such as **earth elementals** that resemble crayfish and that locals call crawlers. Stone formations jutting from the mud glow blue-green from the algae that coats them, giving the appearance of glowing stone trees.

A clan of **cave giants** (see *Creature Codex*) became stranded in the plane long ago and have made their home in the area.

Sea Noir (Earth/Fire). In a grey and black desert of limestone dust, a glowing portal of roaring flames hangs in the air above and serves as a sun to scorch the stretches below—and connecting to the Elemental Plane of Fire. This is also where the dao's Soul Forge is located, where pech master blacksmiths craft armor and weapons for their masters. The region presents a perilous journey for those who do not appreciate its dangers. **Purple worms** are known to nest in the area.

Zephyr Peaks (Earth/Air). One of the largest groupings of mountain ranges within the plane is the Zephyr Peaks, reaching far above and almost touching plane's ceiling. It is at this point that it connects to the Elemental Plane of Air. Temples carved into the peaks are kept by an ancient line of **gargoyles**. The incoming wind creates a constant howl.

Reaching the Plane

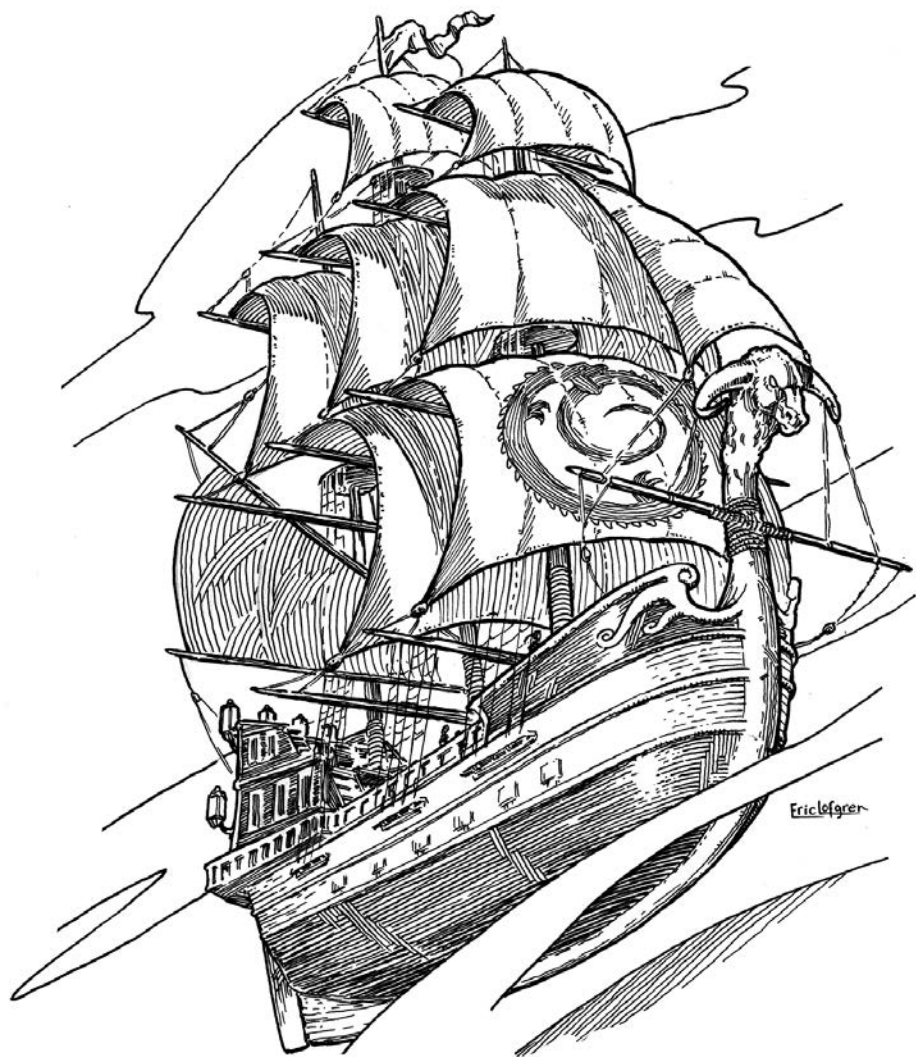
Traveling to the Elemental Plane of Earth from Midgard can follow many paths. Certain subterranean rapids might connect via the Ever River to this plane, such as in the Slate Ravine of Obsidian Marsh. Some of the highest peaks upon Midgard, for those brave enough to leap from their summits, might find themselves transported to the darkness of the Zephyr Peaks. Travelers exploring an active volcano or wandering the blistering deserts of the Southlands might find themselves in the Sea Noir.

ETERNAL RANCOR

The sailing ship's frame seems to be of oak, and the bow sports a silver-horned bull figurehead. The sails are white with a green sea serpent biting its tail. Two small ballistae of silver and oak sit amidships, along with a small cabin at the stern.

Another way of traveling to the Elemental Plane of Earth is a mystical sailing ship, the *Eternal Rancor*, whose story starts with the minotaur mage-turned-corsair named Meja the Neverlost. The corsair had been sailing the coast of Kyprian when an unnatural storm came out of nowhere. The treacherous waters pulled her down. Desperately using her magic to save her ship, she inadvertently connected to the Pontoretto ley line, and the ship was imbued with the elemental energies of earth and water.

Meja went on to find her second life, traveling the Ever River through the multiverse. Before she passed away, she gave her ship to another like her, who was in need and of a fearless curiosity. Its captains have since maintained this tradition—and the ship seems to indicate to its captain the proper time and the proper entity for such a transference.



ETERNAL RANCOR

Wondrous Item, Fabled (5th-Level and Higher Abilities Require Attunement)

The *Eternal Rancor* can sail over sea or land, magically parting the dirt and stone and trees, and sailing just as if it were water, leaving no trace of its passing—and you are its captain.

Seas of Fate (Requires Attunement). As your level increases, you gain the following benefits as captain of the vessel.

5th Level. As captain, the ship's lanterns respond to you and can only be extinguished at your command, you have advantage on ability checks made using navigator's tools while aboard, and any part of the ship that has been damaged or destroyed will magically repair itself daily at dawn.

In addition, the ship can now dive, whether on sea or land and with a swim and burrow speed equal to its sailing speed, creating a protective bubble of breathable air for its crew. There is no limit on the amount of time this ability can be used.

9th Level. As an action, you can cast the *plane shift* spell, affecting the entire vessel and all onboard. The destination is restricted to the Elemental Plane of Earth, the Elemental Plane of Water, or the Material Plane. Once used, this ability can't be used in this way again until 24 hours have passed.

13th Level. The ship's connection to the planes grants it various abilities: it is immune to fire damage, it can't be capsized, the sails are always filled to provide the speed desired, and its maximum traveling speed is doubled.

17th Level. As an action, the ship's ballistae can fire $1d4 + 1$ bolts that trigger the *fireball* spell (6th level) when they hit (DC equal to $8 + \text{your proficiency bonus} + \text{your Charisma modifier}$). The vessel regains these uses daily at dawn.

Inhabitants

The realm is ruled by the dao. Their slaves—that is everyone else, according to them—spend their lives digging endless mines in the search of gems and riches for their tyrant masters. The dao overlord, Khagan Ghorek, rules over the plane as the head of the Council of Khans. Currently, the other members of the council are the khans of the two largest and most important regions within the plane: Golnaz, Keeper of Shadows, and Delatam, the Emerald Mage. (Delatam has been absent of late, but the council has kept it secret. The prevailing theory is that the mage was tricked into partial servitude by a mortal on Midgard.) Other dao serve under the council, each having successively more power and authority than other creatures in the plane.

Other than the dao, some of the plane's most notable inhabitants are earth elementals, gargoyles, pech, and xorn.

Elementals. Earth elementals of various shapes and sizes fill the plane, either bound, following the orders of their dao masters, or wild and roaming the land. The region of the plane can have a marked impact on the elementals' nature, such as the form taken on by the crawlers of the Obsidian Marsh, the fast-flying gargoyles of the Zephyr Peaks, or the sand and lava elementals of the Sea Noir.

Pech. Pech (see *Creature Codex*) make up the majority of the realm's slaves. Their ability to craft and mine is invaluable to the dao. Though a pech's natural inclination is to please their masters, there are some that meet in secret and work toward freeing their people. They sneak other pech out when they can, such as through newly discovered portals to Midgard, where they live out their lives in freedom. To stamp out the resistance, the council has elevated one of the pech's own to the role of mining boss: a greedy and ruthless pech, Overseer Abdius is loyal to the dao and leads the efforts in crushing the spirits of the slaves.

Xorn. Xorn have also been preferentially enslaved to help fill their dao masters' appetite for more gems and precious metals. Few xorn tribes have avoided capture, but those on the loose have banded together under the leadership of the massive Scarlet Maw, trying to attack and deteriorate dao rulership where they can.

Others. Plant life consists of various types of fungi and algae, with the greatest concentration being around Obsidian Marsh. (The local crawlers cover their bodies with the glowing algae.) Within the Sea Noir, the increased light gives rise to varieties of plant life seen nowhere else in the plane, but the scarcity of water keeps this to a minimum.

Locations of Interest

A few of the many notable locations are detailed below.

Jagged Tooth Ravine. Spikes of stone jut from the ravine ridgelines, looking like a massive maw filled with sharp teeth. Wild earth elementals roam the area, but the dominant group are the xorn, led by the massive Crimson Claw, that currently use the ravine to gather. Many are the hunting parties that have come to bring the xorn in as tribute for the council only to never be heard from again.

Soul Forge. Located deep in the Sea Noir is a cluster of rocks surrounded by a sea of limestone dust. Nested at the formation's center, under the scouring light of the Buried Sun (a portal to the Elemental Plane of Fire), there is a temple made of limestone that houses the Soul Forge, where enslaved pechs forge whatever their dao masters demand. The temple is guarded by power earth elementals controlled by the Council of Khans.

Sunken Citadel. Deep in Obsidian Marsh, there are a cluster of stone structures, slowly sinking into the mud. The structures were built by the earliest earth elementals in the region, those that evolved into the crawlers, which currently maintain and rebuild any that submit to the elements. The crawlers do not follow the dao, and the dao—oddly—do not pursue the crawlers. But no one knows why.

Throne of Earth. The seat of power for the Council of Khans, the Throne of Earth, is a multi-level fortress carved from emerald. It is lavishly appointed, an unsubtle reminder of their great wealth and power. This is where the council meets to discuss things of great matters, sitting around their onyx table.

Personages of Note

Some of the plane's interesting inhabitants are described below.

Delatam, Khan of the Emerald Expanse. Also known as the Emerald Mage of the Onyx Depths, the dao is a standing member of the Council of Khans but is currently missing. Unknown by the others on the council, Delatam is currently imprisoned in a magical flask in the hands of a wizard in Midgard's Magdar Kingdom.

Ghorek, Khagan of the Onyx Depths. Also known as the Iron Sword of the Onyx Depths, the dao is the overlord of the plane, ruling as head of the Council of Khans—and is known for his rage. He is feared by all as a warrior of great renown. His body is covered in dark stone, and glowing veins of fire courses through just under the surface. Though a master of many weapons, he greatly favors his massive great sword. Ghorek is greatly angered over Delatam's disappearance and how it makes him look weak.

Golnaz, Khan of the Sapphire Threshold. Also known as the Keeper of Shadows, the dao is a member of the Council of Khans and is a mage of great power. Her skin is as dark as onyx. There are stories told by slaves that she uses her magic to give her sight through all the mineral veins throughout the planes, allowing her always to know one's secrets. Golnaz has a pendant for entering pacts with mortals, who gain power in her name while she furthers her own agenda.

Overseer Abdiesus. The pech slave's loyalty to his masters has earned him the role of mine boss, overseeing the other pech slaves. Abdiesus stands out among his kin by not appearing filthy. He also collects trinkets and gadgets and keeps that handy on his person, displaying or brandishing them prominently, basking in the importance he feels they provide him, such as a golden spyglass and a magical steel collar that acts as a communication device with his masters. He

is known to be cruel to his own people and follows without reservation the wishes of his dao masters.

Scarlet Maw. A **xorn** of massive size, the Scarlet Maw moves quickly through solid earth and stone, appearing out of nowhere to bring chaos and destruction to the dao. The creature's followers are thought to be all the displaced wild xorn from all the tribes the dao have rooted out and enslaved. They regularly attempt to free their kin and raid the dao's supply chains.

Adventure Hooks

Wanderers venturing through the Onyx Depths are seen as outsiders, if they're lucky, or potential slaves. Though with all the many plots in motion in the plane, there is often need for hardy and experienced adventurers.

Here are some recent events for adventurers to tackle:

- The Council of Khans is doing everything in their power to keep the news of the missing khan a secret. Any veteran adventuring party that has proven their skill and discretion could be offered vast riches by the remaining council to return their missing brother.
- There is a sizeable bounty on the xorn known as the Scarlet Maw. The council are literally opening their vaults and granting their favor to whomever succeeds.
- Sensing something is amiss with the Council of Khans, the pech are organizing a massive rebellion, encompassing more slaves by far than any other in memory. They are seeking anyone with a good heart (since they don't have much else to offer) and willing to assist in their continual efforts to free their people.



CONSUMING FLAME: ELEMENTAL PLANE OF FIRE

by Tim Hitchcock

Fire—the element of passion, life, chaos, creation, and destruction—ties all life to the time before existence. In the Elemental Plane of Fire, the flames rise and fall, igniting and smoldering in the eternal, churning dance of primordial powers. Violent and inhospitable, the wild, burning landscapes of the plane remain in a state of constant change. Jagged stretches of basalt and mirror-black obsidian gleam beneath the burning sky. Ripping torrents of scalding wind whip drifts of black sand, ash, and cinders. Smoke clots the air. Gouts of steam and fire spew from cracks in the rock while molten streams rip through the lands. Sulfurous clouds race across the burning sky, raining ash, flaming cinder, and brimstone.

The Elemental Plane of Fire is probably the least hospitable plane of the multiverse to mortals, yet this has done little to dissuade travelers and lore seekers over the passing eons, those who remain ever drawn to the majesty and mystery of the plane and its infamous City of Brass.

Cosmology

The Elemental Plane of Fire is flat, expanding outward from its center, a roiling orb of flames utterly destructive to all life. Planar natives call the core the Everflame, and many

believe that it's sentient, perhaps even an ancient god, and that fire elementals entering the core become one with their creator—or at least commune with it. Around the edges of the Everflame, gateways mark the paths of flame and incineration. Powerful constructs dedicated to fire gods, such as **altar flame golems** (see *Creature Codex*) and **tophets** (see *Tome of Beasts*), stand guard. A current of heat moves from the center outward to where the edges become coterminous with other worlds, creating a series of rings with varying environmental conditions.

Surrounding the core lies the Sea of Ash—a vast, desert-like wasteland of scalding sand encrusted with ribbons of thick ash. The sky is bright red with clouds of flame and cinder, and delicate bits of ash fill the sky, drifting upon the winds like falling snow or forming terrifying burning blizzards when the scalding winds race across the sea. The Sea of Ash extends for miles, eventually washing against the edge of a long, twisted mountain range cut with glistening obsidian spires. A “no man’s land” known as the Ebon Spires marks the third ring’s border. The smooth surface is chipped into sharp, bladed edges, making climbing the spires impossible. Over the eons, travelers have carved precariously narrow footpaths

through the rock. Thousands of passages wind and twist throughout the range, creating a vast and unnavigable maze. Within its chasms and deep ravines lurk outcasts—escaped slaves from the City of Brass and other renegades that survive as scavengers and raiders. On the opposite side of the Ebon Spires, the peaks taper off into a broad expanse of flat black stone known as the Basalt Barrens. Intense heat rises from the stone, blurring vision and transforming everything beyond 60 feet into wavering images and unrecognizable shades. Past the Basalt Barrens, the plane loses its form and transforms into the Molten Rim, where Yggdrasil's roots attempt to thread into the edges. The Rim also lies coterminous with the Ever River, connecting it to the Evermaw and the Shadow Realm.

By its violent and inhospitable nature, the Elemental Plane of Fire burns everything that isn't immune to fire. All planar natives possess immunity to fire, and fire makes up some form of their physiology. Conversely, visitors need to protect themselves when traveling its harsh environments. In various locations of the ring, travelers may encounter a variety of hazards.

Spontaneous Combustion. Creatures not immune to fire damage occasionally burst into flame with little reason or explanation other than they don't belong in the Elemental Plane of Fire. Once per day, non-natives roll 1d20. If they roll under their character level, they begin to combust. The victim begins smoldering and must make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw, taking 13 (3d8) fire damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one. At this point, PCs should work to cool the victim by any means available, such as cold or water-based spells. If the victim isn't cooled, then they catch on fire on the next round. After that, the victim continues to burn until someone extinguishes the flames or until they combust. Each round, the victim

remains on fire, roll 1d6. On a roll of 6, the victim combusts. Creatures within 10 feet of the explosion must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 55 (10d10) fire damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one. The combusting individual makes this save with disadvantage.

ELEMENTAL BREACHES

Fire has such a domineering presence in the plane, it can be challenging to notice the influence of the other planes. Yet their presence is never missing for long.

Burning Sirocco (Fire/Air). Searing winds, burning cinders, and hot blinding ash frequently rip across the plane. Near Everflame and across the Sea of Ash, travelers have a 50 percent chance of encountering them per hour. The chance decreases to 30 percent in the Basalt Barrens and 15 percent at the Molten Rim. PCs caught in a sirocco have obscured vision and take 1d6 fire damage per minute. Each minute they remain in the area, they must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw (+1 DC per each additional minute) or gain a level of exhaustion from the intense heat. A character reaching three levels of exhaustion within the area of effect is also blinded. If the character reaches five levels of exhaustion, ash fills their lungs, and they begin suffocating.

Flame Spouts (Fire/Water). A tangled warren of flame-hot tunnels weaves through the plane, starting at the center and snaking outward toward the rim, and these fill with the waters of the Ever River. Fluctuations in the Everflame occasionally send the temperatures in the tunnels into a critical range, superheating the waters and forcing a cascade of surface eruptions, showering everything in a 15-foot radius of each with steam and scalding water. Creatures in the area must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 21 (6d6) fire damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a

successful one. Fortunately, before a flame spout bursts, it makes weird popping noises in the soil. PCs that associate the popping noises with flame spouts can attempt a successful DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check to gain advantage on Dexterity saves to avoid the flame spouts.

Lava Floods (Fire/Earth). Those traveling the Basalt Barrens, near the edges of the Ever River or its fiery tributaries, may occasionally witness lava floods. These occur when a sudden influx of water or other matter causes lava to spill over and sweep across the plains. Once the disturbance ends, the lava retreats into the river. Lava floods are sudden, spreading outward from the shore at a rate of 20 feet per round. They typically expand for 1d6 + 2 rounds before receding at the same rate. As a result, PCs caught in a flood zone come in direct contact with lava.

Reaching the Plane

The Elemental Plane of Fire explodes into coterminous rifts capable of reaching into every plane. These rifts exist in the eye of every flame and the sparks of every strike of the blade. Creatures of pure fire have little trouble reaching the plane—but most creatures cannot travel through fire, so other means are required.

Cinderwood. Where Yggdrasil's roots coil against the Molten Rim stands an endless forest of dead, leafless trees whose charred branches never cease smoldering. A pale, ashen crust forms upon the root surfaces and the tips of the dead branches. Known as Cinderwood, a powerful **thorned sulfurlord** (see Planar Flora in *Creature Codex*) guards its thoroughfare and demands payments of mortal flesh for those attempting passage.

Ever River. A tributary of the Styx-Lethe flows from the Eleven Hells through the Lock of Erebus, passing into the Elemental Plane of Fire. The water around the lock roils, churns wildly, and drops into dark,

unfathomable depths. Giant serpentine **alnarr demons** (see *Creature Codex*) coil about the lock, seeking easy prey. While many have tried to bargain with them, their demonic hunger typically wins over. Beyond the lock, the Ever River's surface catches fire, and the water boils, scalding all life. Its main channel runs straight through the Basalt Barrens and then splits into dozens of smaller tributaries that wind across the land.

Rifts of Light and Shadow. Chasms between the Ebon Spires cut through the plane and rip into the Shadow Realm. Soot-feathered raptors known as **eala** (see *Tome of Beasts*) manifest in coterminous bleeds between the two planes. They swarm around the haunted Road of Black Embers that leads to Smoke in the Shadow Realm. (Of note, similarly, the tips of the tallest spires rip into the heavens.)

Transcendental Incineration. This plane is the true source of all flames. Whenever and wherever a flame manifests, it's drawn directly from the Elemental Plane of fire—essentially, passing through a coterminous rift to whatever plane on which the flame manifests. Creatures born of pure flame can pass through these rifts as can the spiritual essence of those whose material form becomes entirely consumed by flame. Those who worship fire call the phenomenon transcendental incineration.

Withered Walk. This root path passes through Evermaw. After passing through the realm of undeath, the root's color fades to a yellow-gray and becomes nearly lifeless. A winding path of dust and dried bone follows a series of iron lanterns, hanging from metal gallows. Upon the gallows hang desiccated corpses. Violent undead, such as **wraiths** and **firegeists** (see *Tome of Beasts*), possess the corpses and rise to steal life from mortal travelers.

Yggdrasil. The Elemental Plane of Fire connects with Yggdrasil through the great tree's roots. The roots burrow through the

Void, creating a tangled path that passes through neighboring planes of existence. The two most common routes are Withered Walk and Cinderwood.

PHOENIX CARPET

The thing looks like the burning corpse of a giant phoenix, drawing eight kilim carpets suspended in the air like kites. Upon landing, the flaming vehicle extinguishes, revealing a raptor-shaped mechanical framework.

During the primordial age of rifts, the Elemental Lords of Air and Fire formed a pact to arm their mortal champions with an eldritch flying vessel to travel between their worlds. The vehicle became known as the *Phoenix Carpet*, and the elemental lords shared it, taking century-long terms of possession. At present, the Lords of Fire possess the airship. In the past, they have lent it to mortal petitioners. Unfortunately, this act has also drawn the jealous ire of the Lords of Air, who have made several attempts to get the vessel back.

PHOENIX CARPET

Wondrous Item, Fabled (5th-Level and Higher Properties Require Attunement)

In order to access the *Phoenix Carpet*, a mortal must petition and make a pact with whomever currently possess of the vehicle. This requires a caster capable of summoning the lord and making a substantial offering. If the lord accepts, the individual along with allies and gear can board the vehicle and be transported to an arranged destination on the summoner's plane.

The *Phoenix Carpet* can carry up to 16 passengers (two per carpet), or eight passengers and a ton of additional cargo. It can travel at a speed of 30 mph, has AC 15, 300 hp, and a damage threshold of 15. Control can be temporarily relinquished by the lord to the creature to be attuned to it, per their pact. The carpet is controlled by the will of whomever is attuned to it.

Creatures traveling on the *Phoenix Carpet* gain immunity to the energy type associated with the elemental lord they have entered their pact with. If the vessel is attacked, it automatically defends itself with a breath weapon based on the same lord:

- **Breath Weapon (Recharge 5–6).** The *Phoenix Carpet* exhales either a cyclone in a 15-foot radius centered on it (if pact made with air lord) or a gout of flame in a 60-foot line (if pact made with fire lord). Each creature in the area must make a Dexterity saving throw (DC equal to 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Dexterity modifier), taking 63 (18d6) thunder damage (if a cyclone) or fire damage (if a gout of flame) on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one.

Pact of Wind and Flame (Requires Attunement). The elemental lord that the pact is made with grants you temporary stewardship over the vessel. While attuned to the *Phoenix Carpet*, it remains in your service until you dismiss it, the lord that granted you stewardship over the vehicle ends the stewardship, or some magical force breaks your attunement.

As your level increases, you gain the following benefits after gaining access to the *Phoenix Carpet*. Using some of the more powerful abilities can terminate the elemental pact, breaking the individual's connection to the vessel along with their attunement. If the pact breaks in this manner, the *Phoenix Carpet* completes its flight, taking its passengers to the last agreed upon destination before returning to the possession of its elemental lord.

Jealous Lords. Whenever you attempt to command or control the *Phoenix Carpet*, you risk evoking the ire of a rival elemental lord. Roll d100, and if you roll your character level or lower, you attract the attention of a rival elemental lord who



comes seeking to reclaim the vessel. If you refuse to surrender the vessel to the rival lord, it sends a legion of elementals to seize the vessel by force.

5th Level. At any time, you can direct the vessel to change course and travel to additional locations in the same plane or to stop and wait at a location until you command it to travel again.

As an attack action, you can also command the vessel to make a Breath Weapon attack.

9th Level. As an action, you can cast the *plane shift* spell, affecting the entire vessel and all onboard. The destination is restricted to the Elemental Plane of Air, the Elemental Plane of Fire, or the Material Plane. Once used, this ability can't be used in this way again until 24 hours have passed.

13th Level. You can command the vessel to unleash waves of elemental energy in a 60-foot radius. Creatures caught in the burst must make a Dexterity saving throw (DC equal to 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Charisma modifier), taking 22 (5d8) fire damage and 22 (5d8) thunder damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one.

Using this ability more than once per week breaks the pact and your attunement to the vessel.

17th Level. You can command the vessel to utter a plane ripping cry that slashes a rift between your location and either the Elemental Plane of Air or the Elemental Plane of Fire. The rift forms a coterminous storm

(see **Elemental Breach** sidebar) that draws all creatures within 60 feet of it toward its eye and pulls them into the coterminous plane.

Using this ability breaks the pact and your attunement to the vessel.

Inhabitants

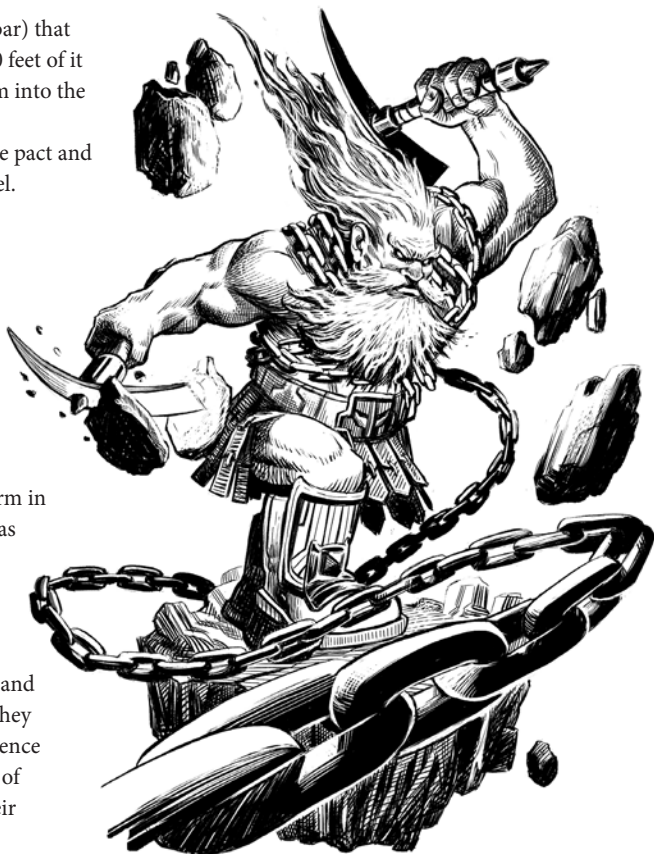
By nature, fire is somewhat anarchic. The motivations of the fire elementals—and perhaps even the plane itself—make it impossible for mortals to determine any overarching rule. Pockets of authority form in the various city-states, such as the City of Brass, forming unique microcosms within the largely inhospitable plane. The efreet of the City of Brass command its social and political structure. Because they frequently extend their influence beyond the Elemental Plane of Fire, most outsiders base their conceptions about the plane on the efreet and their magnificent city. However, other power groups operate throughout the plane, each holding court and sway over the various rings and the surrounding Void.

Nevertheless, the true sovereign of the plane is the Everflame, which the elementals and several other races worship as a deity. They claim the core possesses sentience, that they can commune with it and that its will dictates the ebb and flow of all entities in the plane. Due to the City of Brass's proximity to the core, many of its efreeti lords view themselves as avatars of the fire god. Other races vehemently dispute this claim.

Azers. The dwarf-like **azers** build their largest settlements along the edge of the Basalt Barrens. Though they dominate the region, they lack a centralized authority and

organize themselves as a loose federation of independent clans. Azers live in colonies and jump-mine the metallic asteroids orbiting in the Void drift. Still, independents see themselves as part of a larger federation. They settle disputes and conflicts internally, with most matters arising over mining rights, trade, and resource access. A small percentage of azers live outside of azer society, working as merchants, manufacturers, advisors, and guides in the City of Brass. Others operate interplanar caravans, smuggling operations, or courier services.

Efreet. The undisputed rulers of the fifth ring and the most potent and organized creatures of the plane, **efreet** run the City of Brass, the most trafficked location in the entire plane. The Smoldering Citadel's



influence even extends outside of the plane and most non-natives picture the City of Brass as their conceptualization of the entire Elemental Plane of Fire.

Fire Elementals. Fire elementals are the most frequently encountered creatures in the plane. Born from the Everflame, they manifest anywhere along the rings without suffering limitations. As a result, fire elementals maintain a powerful connection to the plane and converse with it as one might commune with a god. Some believe fire elementals are extensions of the plane in a material form. Others think the elementals are its children. In either case, fire elementals continually blossom, and like the element that birthed them, their primary goal remains to seek, burn, spread, grow, and devour.

Salamanders. A hegemony of **salamander** clans claims the wastes within the Sea of Ash. A clan leader's ability to establish a bloodline to the first god-emperor determines their value in the societal hierarchy. Over the centuries, warlords and mystics have contested individual claims. As a result, territorial clan borders frequently shift during power struggles. Clans center territories on temple-cities dedicated to their god. Clan rulers and mystics claim they receive direct instruction from the Everflame, which they believe to be their fire god and progenitor. Salamander ideology places them as superior to all other races. Still, some suggest salamanders act under the exploitative manipulations of Baal or efreeti pashas. Regardless, infighting over bloodline rights prevents the salamanders from increasing their dominance in the plane.

Others. Nearly all life native to the Elemental Plane of Fire is at least partially composed of flame and immune to fire damage. Elemental fire assumes plant-like forms that blossom quickly and soon after burn out. Flora first emerges along the edges of the Sea of Ash, where flaming tumbleweeds race wildly until they incinerate into dust.

Where the tributaries of the Ever River and other coterminous rifts enter the Basalt Barrens and the Molten Rim, small groves of fire blossoms and burning trees emerge.

Similarly, nearly all sentient creatures birth from elemental fire. **Fire dancer swarms** (see *Tome of Beasts*) drift across the rings of fire while **firebirds** (see *Tome of Beasts*) soar across the sulfuric skies. Wild herds of **sarsaok** (see *Tome of Beasts 2*) roam the Ash Wastes and Basalt Barrens. **Magma mephits** lurk throughout the plane, especially in the churning rivers of in the Molten Rim, acting as emissaries and servants to **lava keepers** (see *Tome of Beasts 2*) and **magmin**. **Steam mephits** are more common along the banks of the Ever River and near gates and coterminous rifts that border with the Shadow Realm and the Elemental Planes of Air and Water. Travelers should be wary of mephits outside their spheres of influence as efreet frequently summon them to serve as messengers and toadies. **Giant sootwing moths** (see *Creature Codex*) are more common along the edges of the plane, often swarming around areas of coterminous flux. One may even encounter the occasional **red dragon** or **brass dragon**. Non-native fire-born dragons infrequently hold council with powerful beings in the City of Brass or attend business with dragons in the coterminous Void.

Locations of Interest

A few of the many notable locations are detailed below.

Blazing Chasms. At various locations throughout the Basalt Barrens, the earth splits into gaping chasms that descend deep into the plane. From the chasms protrude massive basalt columns with stepped tops, rising within a vortex of flame. Azer clans seek out these chasms and build mining encampments in the largest ones. They navigate the chasms upon sagging bridges of charred black chain precariously stretched between the columns.

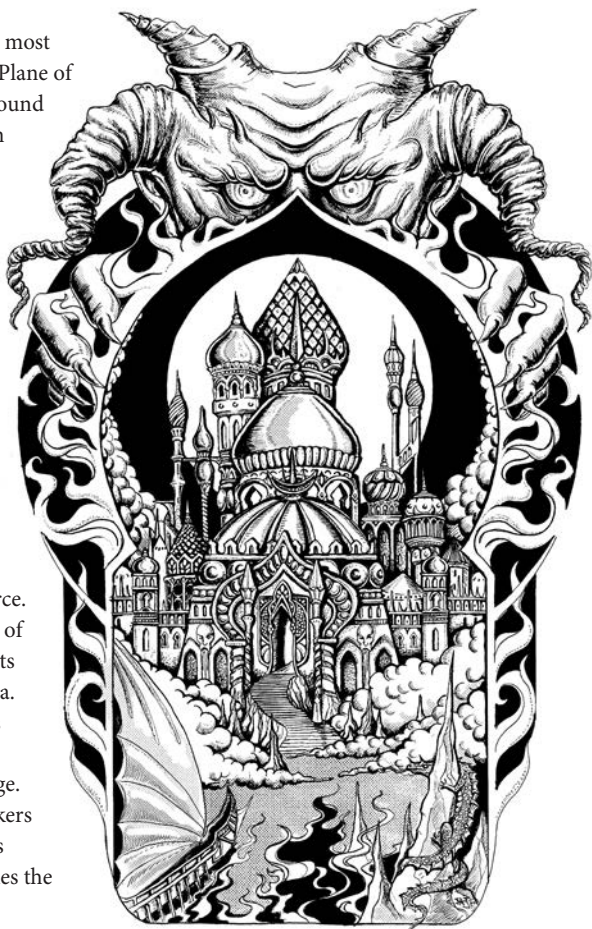
City of Brass. The best-known and most accessible location of the Elemental Plane of Fire is the City of Brass, a neutral ground for trade and diplomacy and a haven to all diabolic exiles and curiosity seekers held under the absolute authority of the efreet and their Grand Sultan Ixingaltrix. Passing centuries unveiled numerous accounts of the wondrous city and its outlandish denizens (see also *Warlock 6: City of Brass*).

Ebon Spires. This anarchic wasteland lies broken into smaller territories ruled by refugees, exiles, cacus giants, or whatever outcast can claim them. In this ring, individuals seize positions of authority by guile, charisma, and force.

Helspyre. Against the blazing edge of Everflame lies a rift gate that connects to the fire giant kingdoms in Valhalla. The fire giants constructed a fortress of bladed towers known as Helspyre around the gate to protect the passage. Currently, a clan of fire giant berserkers under the command of the merciless warpriest Ragiir Blisterbrand occupies the fortress.

Molten Rim. Along the plane's edge, fire and lava spill into the Void. The ground becomes a shifting swamp of molten and semi-solid rock and metals. Most denizens wandering the rim form from the molten morass. Nearly all these creatures offer their fealty to an ancient lava keeper known as the Amorphous Consciousness of Irathris-Ko.

Azers also build mining outposts along the rim and repel off the edge into the Void to mine asteroids. Smeltport, the largest azer outpost, developed into a major hub for trade, crafting, and shipping, and voidships from numerous planes line its docks. In recent years, Smeltport has attracted the attention of the ahu-nixta and now suffers from their increasing raids.



Temple City of the Blistering God. Atop one of the highest peaks in the Ebon Spires, cacus giants chiseled a series of cliff walks and caves that precariously coil around a gigantic effigy of their fiery lord, sculpted into the massive spire's apex. During raids, these giants capture prisoners to sacrifice to their god by lighting them on fire and flinging them from the top of the temple spire.

Personages of Note

Some of the plane's interesting inhabitants are described below.

Cacus Giants. Clans of foul-tempered, violent **cacus giants** (see *Creature Codex*) keep court in the Ebon Spires. They chisel out

crude caves high in the taller spires and crags, allowing them to keep watch over everything below. Most of their resources come from raids and open warfare. Cacus giants worship the Elemental Plane of Fire as a god and believe themselves its progeny. Over the centuries, both the efreet and the salamanders have attempted to conscript or enslave them. As a result, they are fiercely xenophobic and attack all outsiders on sight.

Glauvistus. Glauvistus (adult **flame dragon**, see *Tome of Beasts*), the primordial fire dragon, keeps a hidden lair somewhere in the Elemental Plane of Fire, beneath the Molten Rim in the underbelly of the plane. It is likely near a gate or time ripple through which she can travel freely. Beyond the rim, her dragon disciples and children live in nesting lairs within the drifting rock floating in the Void.

Igris-Syr the Immolator. An enormously bloated salamander empress of the city-state of Irathhriiyer seeks to unite all the cities of the Sea of Ash under her banner. Rumors circulate that she holds pacts with several arch-devils, and her ultimate goal is to lead a united nation against the City of Brass, to seize control of the entire plane as an offering to the lords of the Eleven Hells. Half the city-states support the Immolator's claim while the rest remain resistant. The escalating struggles create a constant demand for mercenaries, spies, and assassins.

Recused. Within an isolated chasm in the Basalt Barrens, a fortified encampment of exiles sits at the mouth of one of the larger and more stable flame spout tunnels. Operated by escaped slaves from the City of Brass and the salamander empires, they call themselves the Recused. Under the guidance of a small council of elders, the Recused actively work to help other victims and exiles escape servitude from the efreet, salamanders, and other would-be lords. Over the centuries, they successfully navigated several reliable routes through the volatile warrens of the flame sprouts.

Adventure Hooks

The Elemental Plane of Fire isn't a place for the unmotivated. Luckily, there is limitless potential. Here are a few possibilities for adventuring parties:

- An azer mining colony recently uncovered a new mineral on a giant asteroid drifting off the Molten Rim. They've been using the mineral to produce an alloy capable of absorbing massive amounts of heat. Several interested parties now target the colony, each desperate to acquire and weaponize the discovery. One of the interested parties hires the players to pay a visit to the colony, establish a relationship with the miners, and defend them against those who seek to take the alloy by force.
- A demon escapes from a celestial prison, slaying several of the angelic host with a sacred blade. His escape led him into conflict with the **Herald of Fire** (see *Creature Codex*). The herald now holds the demon captive and wishes to trade his prisoner. The temperamental herald has called for a summit to discuss his terms and demands. However, he refuses to meet anywhere but the Elemental Plane of Fire. PCs are sent to negotiate his terms and, if possible, return with the prisoner.
- The PCs extinguish three magical, flaming seals to enter an ancient, treasure-laden tomb. Doing so grants them access but unwittingly awakens and releases the tomb's primary occupant, a **mummy lord**. Desperately outmatched, the adventurers must find a safe route of escape. Through exploration and investigation, the adventurers discover they can only rebind the mummy lord by traveling to the Elemental Plane of Fire to reignite the flaming seals.

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